

HOW TO CREATE A SENSORY BOX



A sensory box is a container filled with any kind of tactile items that kids explore with their hands. A sensory box offers children a way to use sight, touch, and smell to engage their senses. When a child is engaged in touching, feeling, and playing, it has a calming effect and helps him/her relax and manage his/her emotions. It can also foster cooperation and resolve conflicts.

When considering making a sensory box, keep these thoughts in mind:

- ▶ Make sure that the box and contents can be easily cleaned and sanitized.
- ▶ Avoid small items children could choke on if using for younger children.
- ▶ Please make sure that the contents of the box can be used on Shabbat.

Target Different Senses

Touch: Include whatever you use for the filler, and also pebbles, marbles, buttons, leaves, seashells, Duplos or Legos, and plastic dinosaurs or farm animals, pipe cleaners, and hair scrunchies.

Smell: Include tea bags, cinnamon, pepper flakes, and lavender.

Hearing: Include bells, plastic eggs filled with popcorn or marbles, squeaky toys, paper for crumpling, and small instruments like xylophones and kazoos.

Taste: Include cooked pasta, dry cereal, marshmallows in different sizes and colors, and Jello or puddings in different colors.

Use a covered box or bin to contain all of the materials. A plastic storage bin, without any sharp edges, makes a good container. It will be used for playing and exploring.

Start by adding a filler or base using rice, dry pasta, popcorn kernels, cotton balls, pompoms, and/or beads.

Provide plastic magnifying glasses so children can explore leaves, rocks, and marbles.

Add measuring cups, spoons, scoops, funnels, small cups, and cookie cutters to increase the level of play.

Put a mat, shower curtain, or plastic sheet down on the play area to help make clean-up easy. Sensory boxes can sometimes leave a bit of a mess. Some of the items in the sensory box can only be used once, like pudding, and some will need to be replenished from time to time.

Bar and Bat Mitzvah Sensory Box Project Sponsorship Opportunity

Friendship Circle of Fairfield County CT developed a unique sponsorship program for Bar and Bat Mitzvahs. They create and donate sensory boxes to local synagogues so they can become more inclusive and accommodating of individuals with diverse needs in shul. Once the box is completed, they create a plaque which is affixed on the sensory box that includes the Bar/Bat Mitzvah's name and Friendship Circle of Fairfield County.

They ordered items for their sensory boxes from [Fun and Function](#), an organization that was founded by a Jewish occupational therapist. Fun and Function has a full array of items for sensory boxes along with lots of other useful resources. Here some of the items Friendship Circle of Fairfield County included in their sensory boxes:

[Noise Cancelling Headphones](#)

[Discovery Disks](#)

[Transformer Sensory Sack](#)

[Busy Fingers Fidget Lap Pad](#)

[Hand eye coordination scarves](#)

SAMPLE PLAQUE

This sensory box was created by _____
in honor of ShabbaTTogether for _____ synagogue.
Inspired by Friendship Circle and Chabad of _____.